

CHINA UNIVERSITY ADMISSION INTERVIEW

20 Probable Questions with Answering Tips

SELF-INTRODUCTION

Question 1

Please introduce yourself.

Answering Tips:

- Structure your introduction as: name and country → academic background → key achievement or experience → why you are applying. Aim for 2 to 3 minutes.
- Only mention items you can expand on if asked — interviewers at most Chinese universities build follow-up questions directly from your self-introduction.
- Avoid reading from a script. Practice until it flows naturally. End with a sentence connecting your background to the specific program.

MOTIVATION

Question 2

Why do you want to study in China?

Answering Tips:

- This is the single most repeated question across all Chinese universities. Generic answers about food, culture, or the Great Wall are not sufficient.
- Connect your answer to something concrete in your academic field — for example, China's rapid advancement in infrastructure, engineering, technology, or public health relevant to Cameroon's development context.
- Show that you have researched China's role in your field and can articulate how studying there gives you an advantage you could not gain elsewhere.

Question 3

Why did you choose this university specifically?

Answering Tips:

- Research the university before your interview: identify a specific faculty member, research lab, curriculum feature, or partnership that is relevant to your goals.
- Mention something precise — not just its reputation or ranking. Interviewers at competitive schools often follow up with: 'We are your first choice, correct?'
- Frame your answer to show the fit is mutual: this university needs what you offer, and you need what this university provides.

Question 4

Why did you choose this major?

Answering Tips:

- Avoid vague statements such as 'I have always been passionate about it.' Tie your interest to a real experience, a problem you want to solve, or a project you have worked on.
- Show intellectual depth: what aspect of the field excites you most, and how does this program help you develop in that direction?
- If you are switching fields from your previous studies, prepare a clear explanation for the transition that makes logical sense.

Question 5

What are your strengths and weaknesses?

Answering Tips:

- For strengths, name one or two and immediately back each up with a concrete example — a project, competition result, leadership role, or academic outcome.
- For weaknesses, choose something genuine but not disqualifying. More importantly, explain the specific steps you are already taking to address it.
- Avoid clichés such as 'I work too hard' or 'I am a perfectionist.' Interviewers have heard these many times and they reflect poorly on self-awareness.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Question 6

Please walk us through your academic achievements and extracurricular activities.

Answering Tips:

- Organize your answer chronologically or by theme (academic, leadership, community). Do not list everything — select three to four highlights that are most relevant to the program.
- For each achievement, briefly state what you did, what your role was, and what the outcome or impact was. Numbers and specifics are more convincing than general descriptions.
- Mention extracurricular activities that show qualities the university values: leadership, initiative, community contribution, or international awareness.

Question 7

How would you rate your academic performance, and what subject are you strongest in?

Answering Tips:

- Be honest and confident. If your overall GPA is not your strongest point, acknowledge it briefly and pivot to the subjects or projects where you excelled.
- Back up your rating with evidence: class rank, a strong grade in a key subject, or a teacher's assessment.
- If one grade is noticeably low, do not wait for them to ask — address it briefly and focus on what you learned or how you recovered.

Question 8

Your grades in [a subject] appear lower than expected. Can you explain why?

Answering Tips:

- Never blame a teacher, a difficult curriculum, or external circumstances without taking personal responsibility as well.
- Acknowledge the outcome, explain the context honestly (illness, a period of adjustment, a subject taught in a different language), and immediately pivot to evidence of recovery or strength in your core subjects.
- End on a forward-looking note: what you have done or are doing to ensure this does not affect your university performance.

Question 9

Can you summarize your personal statement or study plan?

Answering Tips:

- Know your own written application documents well enough to speak about them fluently without referring to them.
- Do not simply recite the document. Speak about it — why you wrote what you wrote, what experiences shaped your study plan, and what you hope to achieve.
- Interviewers at universities such as SJTU, Fudan, and ZJU often use the personal statement as the primary source for follow-up questions, so any claim you made in writing must be something you can discuss in depth.

Question 10

What was the biggest challenge you have faced in your studies, and how did you overcome it?

Answering Tips:

- Use the STAR structure: Situation — what was the context? Task — what were you expected to do? Action — what specifically did you do? Result — what was the outcome?
- Choose a challenge that demonstrates resilience, problem-solving, and growth — not one that simply shows you worked hard at something easy.
- Make the conclusion forward-looking: what did you learn from this experience, and how will it help you succeed in a demanding university environment in China?

COMMITMENT

Question 11

If you do not receive a full scholarship, will you still attend this university?

Answering Tips:

- This is a commitment test. Universities ask it to determine whether you are genuinely motivated or simply chasing funding.
- Be honest about your financial situation, but reaffirm clearly that this university is your first choice. Do not promise what you cannot deliver.
- If a partial scholarship would make attendance impossible, say so respectfully and ask about additional funding options rather than simply saying no.

Question 12

What other universities have you applied to? Is this your first choice?

Answering Tips:

- Being honest about other applications is acceptable and expected. What matters is how you frame this university's position among your choices.
- Make it clear — with genuine reasons, not flattery — why this program ranks at the top of your list.
- Avoid naming universities that seem to contradict your stated motivation. If you say you chose China for its engineering leadership and you have also applied to a business school in Europe, be ready to explain the logic.

Question 13

Why should we admit you over other applicants?

Answering Tips:

- This question appears most at competitive programs. Do not be modest to the point of being vague.
- Articulate what makes your profile distinct: your country or regional background, a specific skill set, a project, or a perspective that other candidates are unlikely to have.
- Frame it as a contribution to the university, not just a list of your qualities. Show how your presence benefits the class or the faculty's research.

FUTURE PLANS

Question 14

What are your career goals after graduation?

Answering Tips:

- Interviewers want to know you have thought beyond the degree. A clear, realistic career goal is more impressive than an open-ended answer about 'exploring opportunities.'
- Connect your goal directly to this program: explain what skills or knowledge it gives you that you cannot gain elsewhere, and how those translate to a specific role or field.
- For students from Cameroon applying to Chinese universities, it is strong to mention contributing to your country's development or to Cameroon-China cooperation in infrastructure, engineering, or public health.

Question 15

Do you plan to work in China after graduation or return to your home country?

Answering Tips:

- There is no universally correct answer. What matters is that your answer is coherent and connected to your goals.
- If you plan to return to Cameroon, explain how the Chinese degree and network will strengthen your impact at home. If you hope to work in China first, demonstrate that you understand the professional environment there.
- Avoid vague or evasive answers. A well-reasoned plan — even a flexible one — shows maturity and seriousness.

Question 16

How will this specific degree help you achieve your goals?

Answering Tips:

- This is a logic-check question. The interviewer wants to confirm that your choice of degree, university, and country form a coherent argument.
- Name specific aspects of the curriculum, the faculty's expertise, or the university's industry connections that align with your stated goals.
- Avoid generic phrases like 'it will open many doors.' Show that you have read the program's course structure and can explain exactly which elements are most useful to you.

LOGISTICS & ADAPTATION

Question 17

How do you plan to manage the language and cultural differences in China?

Answering Tips:

- If you have any Chinese language ability (HSK level or informal study), mention it here. If not, be honest and outline your plan to develop it.
- Show that you have thought practically about daily life in China: studying in a second or third language, navigating a different academic culture, and managing homesickness.
- Universities value students who are self-aware and proactive. Mention any prior experience adapting to a new environment — a different city, a different school system, or an exchange program.

Question 18

What do you know about life in China or the city where the university is located?

Answering Tips:

- Do basic research before your interview: the city's population, climate, key industries, and anything notable about the university's campus or surrounding area.
- Connect what you know about the city to your goals — for example, if the university is in a city known for manufacturing or technology, explain how that environment will enrich your studies.
- Showing geographic and cultural curiosity signals that you are serious about the experience, not just the degree.

PERSONAL

Question 19

What are your hobbies and interests outside of academics?

Answering Tips:

- Choose activities that reveal something meaningful about your character — leadership, creativity, community service, or intellectual curiosity.
- Be specific. 'I enjoy reading' is weak. 'I read biographies of engineers and political leaders to understand how people build lasting systems' is far more compelling.
- If you have a hobby that connects to your major or to China (a Chinese cultural practice, a technology project, a sport played in China), mention it — it makes the answer memorable.

CLOSING

Question 20

Do you have any questions for us?

Answering Tips:

- Always prepare at least one or two genuine questions. Saying 'No, I think everything is clear' leaves a poor final impression.
- Good questions demonstrate that you have researched the program: ask about a specific professor's research, the thesis or final project structure, opportunities for internships in China, or how the program connects students with industry.
- Avoid asking about things clearly stated on the university's website. The question should show that your curiosity goes beyond what a simple Google search would reveal.

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